

APPENDIX II

56-83-58

DOCUMENTATION OF RARE BIRD SIGHTINGS
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

A

Species: Purple Finch; Carpodacus purpureus
(Vernacular name) (Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students -- those studying occurrences 50 years from now -- must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Dates (s): 3/19/83 and 3-4 other dates when it snowed Time Bird Seen: 8 AM - 5 PM - visits related to weather to _____

Locality: 1515 Cheyenne Blvd Colorado Springs CO

El Paso Co

Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: Bushnell 8x30 Binoculars; Bushnell 20~45 Telescope

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: Nikkormat w/ 135mm lens

Number of birds seen: 2 Sex: M & F Plumage: _____

Light conditions: Overcast

Distance from bird, and how measured: 10'-15' - 1/2 distance from house to street

Describe the bird's overall behavior: Seen feeding with house finches, juncos, siskins and Am. Goldfinch during several spring storms 1983. Fed mostly on ground, occasionally from platform feeder.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird: Front yard. Observed from kitchen and dining room windows. Bird used cover of 15' lilac bushes, scrub oak and plum, elm and fir trees.

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

Richard Bunn 2727 Main St Colo Spgs CO

Eleanor Wills 540 Asbury Pl Colo Spgs CO

APPENDIX II Continued

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough). Describe what you actually saw in the field.

Female - Darker brown than house finch ♀, breast stripes heavier and darker. Distinct dark brown eye patch, appearance of light line above eye. Slightly larger than house finch ♀

Male - Distinct dark eye patch, slightly larger than house finch. Coloration cranberry washed throughout body. No breast stripes, indistinct stripes on sides near wings

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

No calls heard

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

House finch - frequents yard. Initially, general appearance different - caused close investigation to note differences stated above

Prior experience with this and similar species:

House finches visit yard daily year round. First sighting of Purple Finch

This report was written from notes made during _____ after _____ observation; from memory ✓.

Name (print) : John A. Maynard
Mailing address: 1515 Cheyenne Blvd Colorado Springs CO 80906
Signature: *John A. Maynard*

Return Form To:

CFO Records Committee
c/o Curator--Zoological Collections
Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205